II. "Come on, pour me some wine"

ألا فاسقِني خمرًا وقلْ لي هي الخمرُ ولا تسقني سرًّا إذا أمكن الجهرُ
ولا تسقِيَنْ منها المُرائين قطرةً لأنّ رياء الناس عندي هو الهُجرُ

'alā fa-sqinī khamran wa-qul lī hiya l-khamrū wa-lā tasqinī sirran 'idhā 'amkana l-jahrū
wa-lā tasqiyan minhā l-murā'īna qaṭratan li-'anna riyā'a n-nāsi 'indī huwa l-hujrū[146]

Meter (*al-ṭawīl*): SLX SLLL SLX SLSL / SLX SLLL SLX SLLL.

This is a combination of a Bacchic and homoerotic love poem (*ghazal mudhakkar*), included in the *khamriyyāt* (wine poetry) section of Abū Nuwās's *Dīwān*.

Come on, pour me some wine and tell me it is wine:
Don't pour it secretly when one can do it openly.
Don't pour a single drop of it for hypocrites:
hypocrisy to me is mere obscenity.[147]
A good life for a man is being drunk and drunk again:
when that goes on and on, time seems to shrink for him.
To see me sober: I would be a fraud, for sure;
to totter in a stupor: that is my neat gain.
So speak your lover's name; no more allusions: 5
there is no good in pleasures that are veiled,
No good in being outrageous without impudence,
nor in licentiousness not followed up with unbelief,
Together with a brother-friend in revelry, his brow
a crescent moon surrounded by bright stars.
There was this woman selling wine I roused at night,
Orion being on the rise, when Aquila had plunged.
She said, "Who's knocking there so late?" We said, "A band
with lightweight water skins,[148] who need some wine.
They also must have whores." "Now what about," she said, 10
"a bright-eyed boy instead, like a gold coin, with languid looks,

A joy to those who whore, a pleasure to the pederast:
two things combined in one?"
We said, "Yes, bring him here: someone like that,
dear lady, we can't bear to be without."
She brought him: like a twig, shaking his bum:
you'd think it magic, but no magic there!
The likeness of the moon at night when it is full,
with slender waist and saw-edged pretty teeth.
15 To him each one of us applied himself in turn,
breaking our fast with him, after long abstinence.
We spent the night while God saw us, a wicked band,
trailing the trains of sin. No idle boast!

A Lampoon

man yan'a 'anhu maṣāduhū
takfīhi fīhā naẓratun

Meter (*al-kāmil,* shor
replaced by L).

This mocking poe
Ḥammād is relatively
scene, such as other li

Other people's hunting gr
but Zunbūr's hunting g
One glance at them will su
drinks blood of lice (no
Ah, many a creature lurki
flanked by its nits,
Spreading its mischief wit
when it creeps along—
Ah, many a jumping-jack
by his jumping!
He was killed by the sharp
sheathed in his finger.
Bravo, you hunter whose
are his nails!